

BY-LAWS AND ORGANIZING DOCUMENT
OF THE
American Ramallah Federation Human Services Network
(ARFHSN)

Article I. Organization:

The American Ramallah Federation Human Service Network (ARFHSN) is a Non-Governmental Organization (NGO), organized as a non-profit corporation incorporated under the laws of the State of Michigan. It shall be referred to in this By-Laws and Organizing Document in its abbreviated name (ARFHSN). The American Federation of Ramallah Palestine shall be its supporting organization.

Article II. Goals and Purposes:

(ARFHSN) shall be an educational and charitable organization. It shall seek to raise funds from the general public and from governmental and institutional grants to be used for initiating and developing educational and charitable programs for the general public in communities in the United States of America and the Palestinian Territories as permitted by the laws of the United States of America.

(1) The educational programs, among others, shall include:

- (a) Opening job training centers for adults to provide them with the skills to enter the job market and become productive members of their communities.
- (b) Provide scholarships and grants for the youth who aspire to enter vocational and skill trade schools and institutions.
- (c) To publish educational materials and sponsor seminars to enlighten, acquaint and make the general public, especially the senior citizens, aware of the services available to them in the community and governmental sectors.

(2) The charitable programs, among others, shall include:

- (a) Sponsoring programs to provide assistance to the elderly in their social, recreational, health and physical fitness areas.
- (b) Assisting the needy families with temporary food and shelter.
- (c) Initiating non-profit business opportunities to provide employment through economic growth and development programs in the Palestinian Territories supported by general public contributions and private institutional and governmental grants in order to help reduce high unemployment and provide ways and means in helping to eliminate poverty.

Article III. Organizational Structure of (ARFHSN):

Section 1:

The American Federation of Ramallah Palestine (AFRP) is an independent, non-profit corporation incorporated in the State of Michigan and registered with the U.S. Internal Revenue Service as 501 (c) (4) tax exempt organization with IRS Ein number _____. It is only acting as a supporting organization for (ARFHSN).

Section 2:

ARFHSN shall be governed by a Board of Trustees (BOT) consisting of fourteen (14) members who shall be elected by the Board of Directors of the American Federation of Ramallah, Palestine (AFRP). All members of the BOT shall be members in good standing with the American Federation of Ramallah, Palestine. Six (6) members of the BOT shall be from the AFRP Board of Directors, one is to be elected from each of the communities of Detroit, Jacksonville, Houston, San Francisco/ San Jose, Chicago, and Metro-Washington D.C.... These communities are selected because the majority of our population resides in these American-Ramallah communities.

The remaining eight (8) members of the BOT shall be elected as independent members, who are not associated with or affiliated with the BOD of the AFRP. These members, of ARFHSN shall be elected by the BOD of AFRP. One member will be elected from each of the following cities and their metro cities. These cities are Detroit (See Section 4: B), Jacksonville, Houston, San Francisco / San Jose area, Washington D.C., Chicago, Knoxville/Birmingham and representing the communities of: New York / New Jersey, Kentucky/Cleveland, Los Angeles/ San Diego. In addition to the cities listed above, members of the BOT can be elected from any city, a Ramallah native who resides in the United States.

The initial BOT shall be elected in the following manner:

The first five (5) highest vote getters shall serve for a term of three years. The second five (5) highest vote getters shall serve for 2 years and the third four (4) highest vote getters shall serve for 1 year. Thereafter each year the Board of Directors of AFRP will elect the BOT to replace those whose terms have expired.

In the event that a vacancy occurs on the BOT, they AFRP (BOD) will fill up the vacancy from the same metro areas who will serve for the remainder of the term of the member to be replaced. In case of a tie in between the candidates, the chairman of the BOT will break the tie by flipping a coin between the contestants.

Section 3:

No member of the BOT shall not serve more than two consecutive terms on the board. However he/she can run again after the passage of two years on his/her ceasing to be a member of the BOT.

Section 4:

The officers of the ARFHSN shall be:

- A. The Chairman of the BOT shall be elected by the members of Board of Trustees. He shall preside over the meetings of the Board but he cannot vote on issues before Board unless there is a tie.
- B. The other two officers of ARFHSN are: a. The Treasurer b. The Executive Administrator, both shall be the two members of the BOT from the Detroit area. Since headquarters office of ARFHSN will be in Westland, Michigan building of the Ramallah Club of Detroit where the office of the ARFP is located. These two officers to be functioning smoothly and efficiently they must be located in Detroit area. The Executive Administrator will do the Secretarial work needed and daily affairs of the organization. However, all major decisions must be taken upon consultation with the chairman, who will decide when a vote of the BOT is necessary.

Section 5:

All checks authorized by the BOT must be cosigned by two signatures to be designated by the Board.

Section 6:

Members of the BOT shall receive no compensation while serving on the Board. However they may be compensated for expenses incurred in attending a meeting of the Board if the matter cannot be handled by conference calls.

Section 7:

The Board of Trustees (BOT) shall supervise, manage, and administer the programs and funds of ARFHSN. However these powers shall be limited by any directions or policy decisions made by the Board of Directors of (AFRP).

The BOT shall comply with these directions and policy decisions to insure compliance by BOT with the tax exempt status of ARFHSN as a 501 (c) (3) organization.

The BOT shall submit to the AFRP Board of Directors, beginning six months after its election, and every six months thereafter, a financial and operational report. However, the president of the AFRP can request information from the officers of the BOT in between these reports, and they must comply with his requests.

Section 8:

All contracts of employment involving the rank of director, manager and higher shall be approved by the Board of Directors of (AFRP).

Section 9:

The Board of Directors (AFRP) shall retain a certified accountant outside of Ramallah community to certify the financial operations of the funds and grants received. The fiscal year is June 1 to May 31; Amended from January 1 – December 31.

Section 10:

The BOT shall carry liability insurance for two million dollars, with an endorsement to cover the American Federation of Ramallah, Palestine.

Article IV. Dissolution

Upon the Dissolution of this organization, assets shall be distributed for one or more exempt purposes within the meaning of Section 501 (c) (3) of Internal Revenue Code, or corresponding section of any future federal tax code, or shall be distributed to the Federal government or to a state or local government for a public purpose.

Article V. Amendment to these By-Laws and Organizing Document

Amendments to these By-Laws and Organizing Document can be amended by a motion filed by any member of the Board of AFRP in its capacity as the highest governing body of AFRP in its capacity as the highest governing body of ARFHSN, without any reference to the general membership of AFRP for approval. For passage of any amendment, a favorable vote of 60% of the members of the Board of AFRP is needed. The polling of the entire Board shall be required for voting on any amendment. Any number of the members of the Board present shall constitute a quorum to conduct business. On other issues, besides amendments, shall not require, unless five members of the Board request it, or the president determines that the issue is of such importance that it needs the polling of the entire Board.

Article VI. Application for Grants

One of the main goals of the ARFHSN is to pursue steps to apply for grants from the USAID Program

ARFHSN has already been approved as PVO/ NGO candidate organization for applying for USAID grant. The ARFHSN will explore the steps to ask for a USAID grant.

Therefore a committee of Five (5) members shall be created by the chairman of the Board of Trustees of ARFHSN to initiate the program of seeking a grant from USAID. The committee shall be made up of the chairman of BOT, the BOT Executive Administrator/Secretary, President of the AFRP and two more members to be appointed by the chairman of the BOT.

The committee shall seek professional help from individuals who are well versed in applying for grants from USAID. The Board of Trustees shall approve any contract of employment with any person hired to pursue the grant's projects.